FEC50

Fluorouracil, epirubicin and cyclophosphamide on Day 1 every 21 days while beneficial and tolerated, within the lifetime anthracycline limit. Radiotherapy must not overlap FEC.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Heart

Epirubicin / fluorouracil

Baseline assessment; report chest pain, breathlessness or swelling.

2 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy phase

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: call immediately.

3 Hair / scalp

Chemotherapy phase

Hair loss is common. Ask about scalp cooling before treatment where suitable.

4 Mouth

Chemotherapy phase

Painful ulcers or difficulty drinking need advice.

5 Bladder

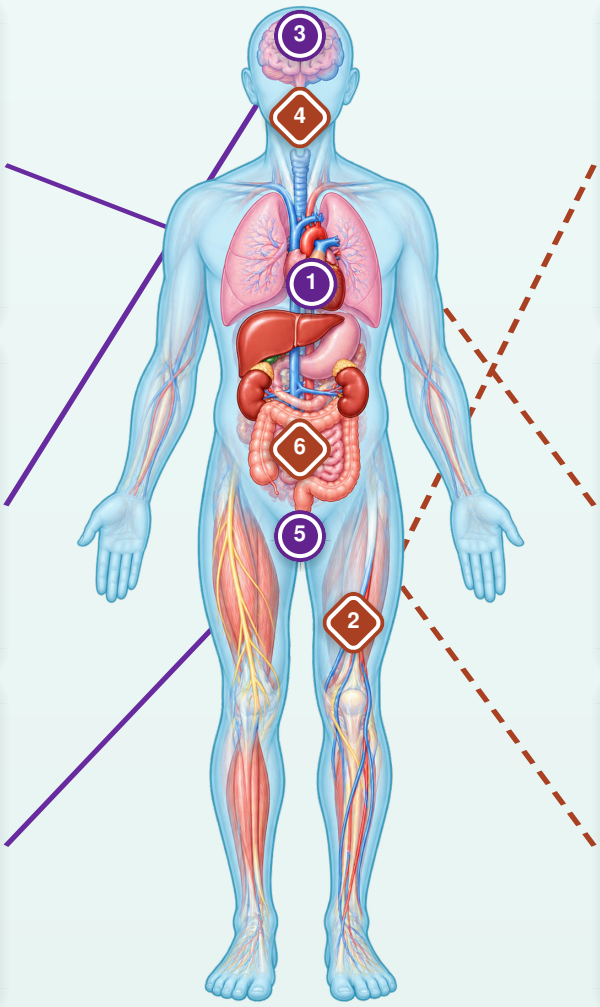
Cyclophosphamide

Report blood in urine or painful urination.

6 Bowel / hydration

Fluorouracil

Diarrhoea, vomiting or inability to drink needs prompt advice.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Selected medicine-specific effects are highlighted. The map is not a complete list; persistent or new symptoms need review even after a medicine stops.

> Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Fluorouracil (5-FU)

- Low blood counts and infection
- Diarrhoea and mouth ulcers
- Rare serious heart symptoms
- Severe toxicity with dihydropyrimidine dehydrogenase (a medicine-processing enzyme) (DPD) deficiency

Epirubicin

- Low counts, infection and mouth ulcers
- Nausea, hair loss and fatigue
- Heart damage, sometimes delayed
- Severe tissue injury if the infusion leaks
- Rare later blood cancers

Cyclophosphamide

- Low counts and infection
- Nausea, vomiting and hair loss
- Bladder irritation / bleeding
- Fertility effects and menopause
- Rare later blood cancers

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

A clear anti-sickness plan

Take the prescribed prevention medicines and keep the rescue instructions. Contact the team if nausea or vomiting prevents drinking.

Infection and growth-factor plan

The team decides whether growth-factor injections are needed and gives the exact days. Fever or suddenly feeling unwell needs immediate advice.

Hydration and urinary symptoms

Agree fluid intake with your team, especially if you have a heart or kidney fluid restriction. Report painful urination or blood in the urine.

Before treatment

Discuss fertility, contraception, other medicines and line access. Tell staff immediately about burning or pain at the infusion site.

DPD testing before fluorouracil

Confirm the DPD result before the first treatment. Testing reduces uncertainty but does not rule out all serious side effects.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00269/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.